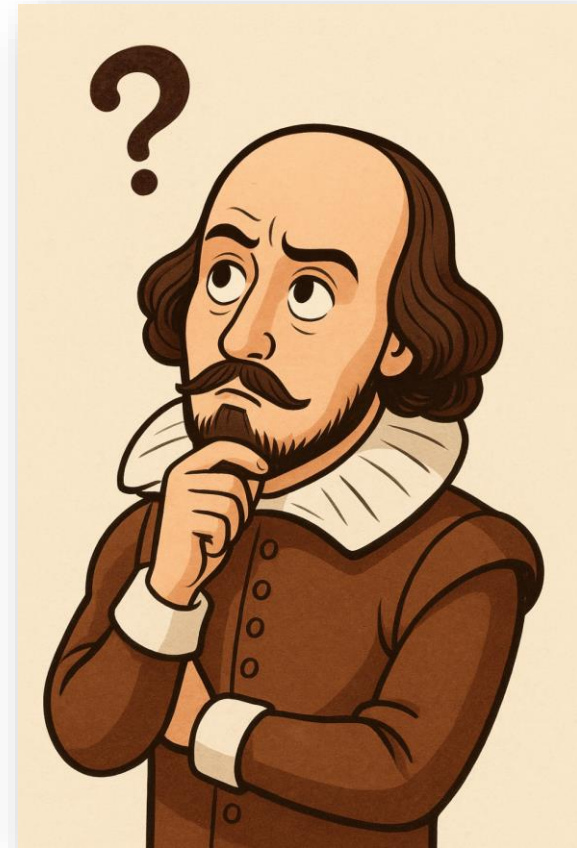


The Primary Purpose Rule

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To use 'the', or not to use 'the',
that is the question.



Without 'the' and with 'the'

school, college, university, church,
temple, mosque, hospital, market,
prison, jail, court, bed, table, etc.

No article when referring to these places for their **primary purpose** or function.

school, college, university, church,
temple, mosque, hospital, market,
prison, jail, court, bed, table, etc.

Use “the” when referring to these places for some **secondary purpose**.

the school, the college, the university,
the church, the temple, the mosque,
the hospital, the market, the prison, the
jail, the court, the bed, the table, etc.

Primary purpose Vs. Secondary purpose

Primary purpose = original purpose

- school → education
- church/temple/mosque → worship / prayer
- hospital → treatment
- Prison / jail → punishment
- market → buying/selling
- court → justice
- bed → rest
- table → meal

Secondary purpose = any other reason (meeting, visiting, describing a building, geographical reference, etc.)

Suresh goes to temple every day.
(He is a devotee.)



Suresh goes to temple every day.
(He is a devotee)



Raj goes to the temple every day.
(He goes there not to pray, but to sell flowers)

These children go to school every day.
(Primary purpose – to study)



These children go to school every day.
(Primary purpose – to study)



The bus driver is going to **the** school.
(Not for the primary purpose of the institution)

1. School

- **Primary purpose (education):**
- Children go to school every day.
- My brother is at school now.
- **Secondary purpose:**
- I went to **the school** to meet the principal.
- Her house is just beside **the school**.

2. Church / Temple / Mosque

- **Primary purpose (worship / prayer):**
- He goes to church on Sundays.
- Devotees go to temple every morning.
- They go to mosque for prayers.
- **Secondary purpose:**
- The tourists visited **the church** because of its architecture.
- He went to **the temple** to meet a friend.
- The guide took them to **the mosque** to explain its history.

3. Hospital

- **Purpose (treatment):**
- He was taken to hospital after the accident.
- My uncle is in hospital.
- **Secondary purpose:**
- I went to **the hospital** to see my friend.
- His office is near **the hospital**.

4. Prison / Jail

- **Primary purpose (punishment / incarceration):**
- The thief was sent to prison.
- He spent five years in jail.
- **Secondary purpose:**
- The minister visited **the prison** to check the security system.
- Reporters gathered outside **the jail**.

5. Bed / Table

- **Primary purpose (rest/eating):**
- I go to bed at 10.00 pm.
- The guests are at table.
- **Secondary purpose:**
- Don't sit on **the bed** with dirty shoes.
- The papers are on **the table**.

Teacher

- **Primary purpose for teacher (teaching):**
- The teacher went to school (institutional function).
- **Secondary purpose:**
- Though it was a Sunday, the teacher went to the school to collect her forgotten laptop.

Doctor

- **Primary purpose for:**
- After the accident, the doctor was rushed to hospital.
- **Secondary purpose (even as a practitioner):**
- The doctor went to the hospital.

Let's Check!

1. After the accident, he was immediately taken to ____ hospital.

a) a

b) an

c) the

d) – (no article)

1. After the accident, he was immediately taken to ____ hospital.

a) a

b) an

c) the

d) – (no article)

2. I went to ____ hospital yesterday to meet my friend.

a) – (no article)

b) the

c) a

d) an

2. I went to ____ hospital yesterday to meet my friend.

a) – (no article)

b) the

c) a

d) an

3. His father is very religious. He goes to _____ mosque every Friday.

a) – (no article)

b) the

c) a

d) an

3. His father is very religious. He goes to _____ mosque every Friday.

a) – (no article)

b) the

c) a

d) an

4. The tourists went to ____ temple to admire its architecture.

a) – (no article)

b) a

c) an

d) the

4. The tourists went to ____ temple to admire its architecture.

a) – (no article)

b) a

c) an

d) the

5. The thief was caught and sent to ____ prison.

a) the

b) – (no article)

c) a

d) an

5. The thief was caught and sent to ____ prison.

a) the

b) – (no article)

c) a

d) an

6. The minister visited ____ prison to check the facilities for prisoners.

a) – (no article)

b) the

c) a

d) an

6. The minister visited ____ prison to check the facilities for prisoners.

a) – (no article)

b) the

c) a

d) an

7. The children are at ____ school now.

a) the

b) a

c) an

d) – (no article)

7. The children are at ____ school now.

a) the

b) a

c) an

d) – (no article)

8. I left my bag at ____ school where I was teaching yesterday.

a) – (no article)

b) the

c) a

d) an

8. I left my bag at ____ school where I was teaching yesterday.

a) – (no article)

b) the

c) a

d) an

9. The lawyer had to appear in ____ court for the hearing.

a) the

b) – (no article)

c) a

d) an

9. The lawyer had to appear in ____ court for the hearing.

a) the

b) – (no article)

c) a

d) an

10. The protesters gathered outside ____ court demanding justice.

a) – (no article)

b) the

c) a

d) an

10. The protesters gathered outside ____ court demanding justice.

a) – (no article)

b) the

c) a

d) an